in insulting the keeper or his wife after admonition, they pay a stiver, and are also punished by having their doors or windows fast closed up.—If they make any noise or disturbance after nine at night to break the rest of their fellow-prisoners, they are ordered to forfeit a schelling, and to be punished at the discretion of the regents: who are likewise empowered to make such alterations as they think proper in the rules: and in case of sickness or old age, to give indulgences to the prisoners, with respect to their diet, times of rising, etc.

In November 1781 the regulations still hung up in the chapel, though the prisoners were removed to Vilvorde.

VILVORDE. The house of correction which was building in 1778, near Vilvorde, for the provinces of Austrian Brabant, is upon as large a scale as any structure of the kind that I have seen. It is situated near the great canal leading to Brussels; and is almost surrounded by water. The ground plot is rectangular, except a sweep before the court of the governor's house. The longer sides are about two hundred and ten yards; the shorter, about one hundred and sixty-seven. At the back of one of the longer sides, fronting the west, I counted eighty windows on a floor, each two feet by one. There are the same number opposite, looking inwards towards the courts. Each of these belongs to a separate room or cell, near six feet and a half by five and a half, and eight feet high; and a long passage eight feet and a half wide runs through each floor, into which all the opposite rooms open. Two floors of this side were finished, making three hundred and twenty rooms; there were two more unfinished, of the same number of rooms. Each of the two shorter sides has one hundred and seventy-six rooms, of the same size as the others, and on as many floors. Part of these sides were finished; so that, including some rooms on each side of the governor's house, about five hundred were ready of the nine hundred and ninety-two. On some vacant ground at the shorter sides, more rooms will be built if wanted. Of so great importance is it wisely judged by these provinces, to keep every prisoner at night by himself, that this vast number of rooms is contrived that each may lodge one person only.

On each side the gate of the court before the governor's house, is a porter's lodge. Prisoners pass this way to their respective wards behind the house. Those committed for life are quite separate from those who are for a limited term: and men totally so from women; not only in their wards, workrooms, and refectories; but also in two distinct chapels. These chapels are octagons of about thirty-five feet; and on each floor the

prisoners have a room looking into them. The workrooms are numerous; about forty feet by twenty: some upstairs; others underground for weaving fine linen: but no prisoners sleep underground. Staircases all stone, six feet wide: some dark cells for confining the refractory. A kitchen forty-seven feet by thirty-four: bakehouse, and slaughter-house large in proportion, and commodious. Convenient apartments for several chaplains: and proper rooms for a military guard. Two spacious infirmaries are designed.

In December 1781 there were in this new house of correction a hundred and sixty-eight men and eighty-six women, clothed in a uniform of light-coloured cloth. They are divided into three classes; and the class to which each of them belongs, together with the number that distinguishes his room, is marked in red, on his clothes and linen. The principal employment of both sexes was spinning cotton; but some of the men were weaving, others making clothes, or shoes; and some of the women were spinning flax, others mending the linen, or making lace. Most of the floors are of a bad plaster, and cannot be washed. There are separate workrooms and refectories to each class, which I found offensive, the windows being all shut though the weather was calm and fine. But the passages, into which all the bedrooms open, were much more offensive. When I first saw this house, I conjectured this would be the case, and though I took the plan, I did not choose to publish it.

While I was there a prisoner was brought in. He was immediately shaved—examined by the surgeon—washed—clothed in the uniform—and then conducted to his class.

There is a room for the magistrates, but on account of its distance from Brussels they too seldom attend. The countenances of the prisoners evidently bespoke inattention and neglect.

The regulations for this house were published at Brussels, 11 February, 1779, in two edicts; the first for the direction of the governors, in French and Low Dutch; the other for the discipline of the house, in French, containing sixty articles, which are well worthy of attention, in any country where similar houses are erected.

GHENT. Here is a prison belonging to the rich monastery of Benedictines in the Abbey of St. Peter. There were thirty-three friars in the house. This fraternity has many lordships, and part of the city in their jurisdiction. The prison joins to the abbot's courthouse. Three dreary dungeons down nineteen steps: a little window in each: no prisoners. I went down in